KARNATAKA: FIGHT FOR A FAIR SHARE
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UPFRONT

MP POLICE: BAND OF BROTHERS
PG 11



MILIND SHELTE

STARK INEQUALITY Skyscrapers near slums in Dharavi, Mumbai, Sept. 2023

ECONOMY

INDIA'S GROWING WEALTH DIVIDE

By M.G. Arun

The rich-poor divide in India has never been a secret. If anything, it has only grown wider. The fact only got reaffirmed in a paper released recently by the World Inequality Lab, a Paris-based research organisation. The country's top 1 per cent income and wealth shares have reached historical highs and are among the highest in the world. By FY2023, the findings reveal, the top 1 per cent of Indians held a 22.6 per cent share in the country's income and 40 per cent of its wealth.

Inequality is said to have declined post-Independence till the early 1980s, after which it began rising and has skyrocketed since the early 2000s, according to the paper, titled 'Income and Wealth Inequality in India, 1922-2023: The Rise of the Billionaire Raj'. The top 1 per cent earned an average of Rs 53 lakh per annum in FY23, as